

Verses on the Meaning of the Praise of Infinite Qualities

Guṇāparyantastotrabatukārikā · Toh 1157 · Derge Tengyur

ཡན་ཏན་མཐའ་ཡས་པར་བསྟོན་པའི་དོན་གྱི་ཁྱེད་ལའུ་བསྟུ་པ་

The Verses on the Meaning of the Praise of Infinite Qualities, whose Sanskrit title is transcribed in the Tibetan as Guṇa Aparyanta Stotra Batu Kārikā and whose Tibetan title is Yönten Tayepar Töpé Dön gyi Tsik Leur Jepa, is a short work of ten verses that its colophon attributes to the great master Dignāga. It condenses into verse the structure of a hymn of praise to the Buddha, the Praise of Infinite Qualities, showing how that hymn covers the cause of awakening in its phases of intention, application, and mastery, then the result, and finally the Buddha's work for the benefit of others, and even noting how many of the hymn's verses are given to each topic. Its colophon records that it was translated into Tibetan by the Indian preceptor Sarvajñādeva and the translator Rinchen Chok, and revised by the chief editor Paltsek. It is Toh 1157 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of praises (stotra).

In the language of India: guṇa aparyanta stotra batu kārikā

In the language of Tibet: Verses on the Meaning of the Praise of Infinite Qualities

Homage to the noble Mañjuśrī.

Not knowing the qualities, freedom from exaggeration,
Freedom from pride, and accomplishing the desired aim:
By the verse endowed with these four points
The introduction to the praise is set forth.

By the cause, the result, and the benefit of others
All the meanings of the praise are gathered up.
Of these, first the cause of awakening,
The result, and the benefit of sentient beings are taught.

By the three phases of intention,
Application, and the exercise of mastery, the cause is taught.
Intention, in its intrinsic nature, is aspiration
For the benefit of others and for awakening.

By five verses and five more
It is taught, together with its four causes.

By the unwanted and the wanted,
By companionship and enjoyment provided, it is taught.

Spiritual lineage, a virtuous friend, compassion,
And deeming it no fault are the causes of the second.
As there are those not on the grounds and those who dwell on them,
Application is here made twofold.

The former have ten perfections,
The others, seven perfections.
Six verses teach six of them;
Two teach one, and three the rest.

The distinctions of the first are intention,
Application, the recipient, and what is to be given.
The first five are taught by one verse each,
The other, undefiled, by two.

Over afflictions, birth, karma,
Skillful means, and bringing beings to full maturity:
The five masteries, together with their purposes,
Are taught by two, two, two, two, and three verses.

Of these, some are not stated explicitly;
They concern the exhaustion of opposing factors.
The result is threefold: awakening,
And faults abandoned and qualities gained.

The benefit of others is threefold: teaching the Dharma,
Its sublime character, and long endurance.
The last verse is the dedication of merit.
Thus the meaning of the praise is taught in summary.

The Verses on the Meaning of the Praise of Infinite Qualities, composed by the
great master Dignāga, is complete.

It was translated by the Indian preceptor Sarvajñādeva and the translator, the
venerable Rinchen Chok, and edited and finalized by the chief editor and
translator, the venerable Paltsek Rakṣita.

Translator's Notes

- In the line naming the three phases of the cause, the Tibetan reads *bstan pa* (teaching) where the sense, and the next lines defining intention, require *bsam pa* (intention); the translation follows *bsam pa*. The phrase *dam nyam pa*, the second aspect of benefiting others, is obscure; it is rendered "its sublime character" because it stands where the prose commentary on this hymn places the nature of the teaching of the Dharma, but the reading is uncertain. "Deeming it no fault" renders *skyon med bsams pa*, the fourth cause of the aspiration for awakening, which the commentary describes as not being turned back by suffering.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.